

SOP-GAS-2900: Compressed Gas Cylinder Handling and Storage

Document owner: Safety Department **Effective date:** 2024-01-25 **Review cycle:** 36 months

Section 1. Purpose and Scope

Governs storage, transport, and use of compressed gas cylinders.

Section 2. Storage

Clause 2.1 — Cylinders shall be stored upright and secured (chained or strapped) to prevent tipping at all times, including “empty” cylinders — an empty cylinder retains residual pressure and hazard.

Clause 2.2 — Oxidizing gas cylinders (oxygen) shall be stored at least 20 feet from fuel gas cylinders (acetylene, propane) or separated by a fire-rated barrier at least 5 feet high.

Section 3. Transport

Clause 3.1 — Cylinder valve protection caps shall be installed whenever a cylinder is moved or not connected for use; cylinders shall be transported on an approved cart, never dragged, rolled, or carried by the valve.

Section 4. Use

Clause 4.1 — A pressure-reducing regulator rated for the specific gas service shall be used; regulators are not interchangeable between incompatible gas services (e.g., an oxygen regulator shall never be used on a fuel gas cylinder).

Clause 4.2 — Cylinder valves shall be closed and regulators bled down before disconnecting; a cylinder shall never be left connected and pressurized when unattended for an extended period beyond the immediate task.

Section 5. Inspection

Clause 5.1 — Cylinders showing damage, corrosion, or a hydrostatic test date beyond the regulatory retest interval shall be removed from service and returned to the supplier, not used pending the next inspection cycle.

Section 6. Records

Clause 6.1 — Cylinder inventory and inspection findings are logged in the Safety Department File and reviewed quarterly.